

To support why mobility frictions are interesting, I want to first explain why mobility is important for cities! I plan to rely on urban economic models—for example, Glaeser presents that cities exist because of economies of scale (he calls them agglomeration economies). Thick labor markets, knowledge spillovers, and, importantly, lower transportation costs encourage businesses, and therefore, people, to live closely to one another. And when transportation becomes easier, productivity increases, and so do wages (I’ve read his book *Triumph of the City* for an urban econ class, but the internet seems to think that his article *Wealth of Cities* might have more mobility related discussion).

So what affects mobility? I want to explore existing literature on the relationship between infrastructure and mobility to advance a further point: the built environment changes how we move. Shahum details how European cities have manipulated their street design to deter car accidents (vision zero refers to the goal of no traffic fatalities), which I think might be a nice contrast to the negative results of New York City roadways detailed in this project. But, I am still searching for more sources to enhance this section.

And, how does this project help? I am incredibly excited to incorporate *Smarter New York City: How City Agencies Innovate* to establish data as a tool for city government. There are a series of chapters, titled “Data, Organization, and Technology”, which I want to use as precedent for using administrative data to answer specific questions. In my case, where is it difficult to move and why?

D’Almeida, A. C. (Ed.). (2018). *Smarter New York City: How City Agencies Innovate*. Columbia University Press. <http://www.jstor.org/stable/10.7312/dalm18374>

Glaeser, E. (2011). *Triumph of the city: How our greatest invention makes us richer, smarter, greener, healthier, and happier*. Penguin Press.

Glaeser, E. L., & Gottlieb, J. D. (2009). The wealth of cities: Agglomeration economies and spatial equilibrium in the United States. *Journal of Economic Literature*, 47(4).

Shahum, L. (2017). *Safe Streets: Insights on Vision Zero Policies from European Cities*. German Marshall Fund of the United States. <http://www.jstor.org/stable/resrep18873>.

Data Sources (courtesy of NYC OpenData)

[311 Service Requests from 2020 to Present](#) - 22.5m x 44

[Motor Vehicle Collisions - Crashes](#) - 2.27m x 29

[Parking Violations Issued - Fiscal Year 2027](#) - 1.5m x 44

[Traffic Volume Counts \(Historical\)](#) - 42.8k x 31